



Wally Provost

Mrs. Ogle Earns Chance in Detroit

RACE fans got one wild, unbelievable look at Mrs. Ogle at the State Fairgrounds track last week. It will be the last look for a while.

We're talking about a 2-year-old filly—not the somewhat more mature Mrs. Ogle, our housekeeper, for whom the thoroughbred was named.

In her first race ever, Mrs. Ogle, to quote Jockey Fred Ecoffey, "was asleep when the starting gate opened." Setting an erratic course, the handsome chestnut was 14 lengths off the pace at the first turn.

However, she swung wide of the pack and won by nine lengths while under moderate restraint in the stretch. Fans were goggle-eyed over the spectacular rally.

Now word comes from the three Omaha owners, George Stryker, Terry O'Neil and Frank Bemis, that Trainer Dwight Clum will include Mrs. Ogle among a vanload of horses he is taking to Detroit's Hazel Park on Thursday.

No Big Sweat

"OBVIOUSLY, she needs more work out of the gate," O'Neil said. "But Clum is convinced Mrs. Ogle is good enough to compete with better horses. After her victory at Lincoln last week she wasn't breathing hard and really hadn't worked up a big sweat."

He said Clum hopes to race the smooth strider in Detroit by the middle of next week.

Mrs. Ogle was stabled here throughout the Ak-Sar-Ben meeting, but the closest she came to seeing action was getting on the also-eligible list for a race July 4.

O'Neil remarked: "If all goes well, we want to have her running for 75-hundred-dollar and 10-thousand-dollar purses at Ak-Sar-Ben as a 3-year-old."

Weaver Popular Here

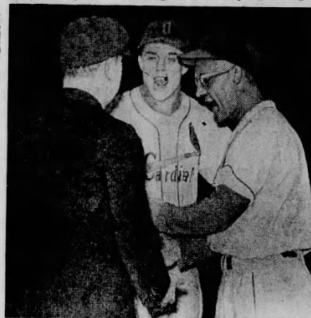
IF EARL WEAVER, the replacement manager, continues to push Baltimore upward in the pennant chase, he could be the American League Man of the Year.

That would delight countless Omahans who recall the spunky bantam's three seasons with the Omaha Cards. In his first campaign here, in 1961, Weaver was voted the most popular player.

Bob Phipps covered those Cardinal teams. He recalls with stimulating clarity the night Weaver was at bat with runners on third and second. "The pitch was into the dirt and Weaver, a quick thinker, stuck out his foot and deflected the ball past the catcher," Phipps relates.

"One run scored. The ump had missed Weaver's trick. While the enraged catcher argued with the umpire, the other runner also scored." Weaver never played in the majors.

"But I saw some great managers in the minors," he said recently. "Johnny Keane. Al Hollingsworth, the old pitcher, George



Ump lectured . . . by Weaver, center, Kissell.

Kissell, a great teacher. And Andy Cohen, the old Giant, a wonderful handler of men."

It was the combination of Kissell and Weaver, both savage competitors, that led Omaha to the Western League championship in '61.

Nebraska-Colorado

UNIVERSITY of Colorado officials predict enrollment at the Boulder school next fall will top 17 thousand for the first time.

The Nebraska football delegation, again fattened by the Omaha Sportscasters' Association tour package, will find new eye-catchers in 15-story and 12-story dormitories.

Those of us who report football games are hoping the new press box will be completed. The old one is scaffolded against an inner wall of the ancient field house; its inhabitants for years have been required to peer through wavy-glass windows, which doesn't do much to settle one's nerves after a night in Denver.

Fred Casati says the ticket office apparently has enough orders on hand to make the game a sellout. With schedule realignment showing the game back to November 16, this could be the most frigid Husker-Buff meeting in years.

No. 1 Race City

A DENVER acquaintance, Leonard Cahn of the Rocky Mountain News, declares: "Pound for pound, based on population, Omaha has to be the top city in the land" for horse racing.

He spoils the compliment by adding: "What else is there to do in Omaha except bet on horses? There's no pro baseball, no big-time pro football or pro basketball."

Leonard, we figure the Omaha Mustangs are at least as entertaining as the Denver Broncos, and we won't trade our pro hockey team for your pro foul-shooters. Omaha has the nation's best amateur baseball attraction, the College World Series, and expects to rejoin Denver in the minors next year.

If you had mentioned that we have nothing to compare with the frolics at the Tropics, we'd have been speechless.

Wally Provost,
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